

[Resume later](#)

0%

Thank you for your interest in our research study! This study is being conducted by the Media Bias Research Group with the goal of developing systems and tools to mitigate media bias and unbalanced coverage in news articles.

In this study (~15 min.), we ask you to read a short introduction to media bias and answer a comprehension question. Afterward, we query demographic data (age, gender, education, English proficiency, political orientation, news reading habits, topic opinion on climate change). The study itself consists of one news article text that we ask you to read and one shorter text afterward. We ask you to report your perception of bias and answer some other questions about your experience reading the texts.

This study is anonymous. That means that we will not record any information about you that could identify you personally or be associated with you. Based on the collected data, we aim to publish scientific papers on effectively communicating media bias. Still, these publications do not allow any inference to you as an individual. Once the study is published, the anonymous data might be made available in a public data repository. Your rights to access, change, or move your information are limited, as the data may no longer be modified after the data has been published. This is because we need to manage your data in specific ways for the research to be reliable and accurate. Once published, we will not be able to delete your anonymous data.

The study itself is not hosted on Prolific but on a dedicated external university server in Germany with LimeSurvey. Once the survey is complete, you will be shown a button that will lead you back to Prolific, where you will receive your payment.

Participation in this study is voluntary. You may choose not to participate, and you may withdraw at any time during the study. If you withdraw, we will delete your data. We kindly ask you to complete the study in one setting as the questions are time-sensitive. Pausing the study is not possible and will result in exclusion. Study completion is necessary to receive the final payment. If you have any questions about the study or study procedures, you may contact info@media-bias-research.org.

***I agree to the processing of my personal data in accordance with the information provided herein.**

👉 Choose one of the following answers

- ☐ I agree.
- ☐ I DO NOT agree.

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5%

Often, the same content is presented in different ways. Sometimes, the wording differs; other times, only a specific part of the information is shared. Depending on the choice of words and the selection of details, articles can convey more than just factual information — for instance, opinions or ideologies. This phenomenon is known as media bias.

Media bias can take many forms. Spin shapes the narrative by simplifying or exaggerating certain aspects of a story, often influenced by the political leanings of the outlet or author. The selection of which information to include or exclude can significantly sway perceptions and opinions. Additionally, articles sometimes use language that reflects a particular attitude or viewpoint — for example, “immigrants” versus “illegal aliens.” The framing of the article and phrases can convey implicit meanings. At the same time, our own political leanings, culture, education, class, gender, and race influence how we interpret articles. Recognizing media bias helps us avoid being misled and promotes a more comprehensive understanding of issues.

What is media bias?

Choose one of the following answers

- ☐ The practice of including only factual information in an article
- ☐ The phenomenon where articles convey opinions or ideologies in addition to factual information
- ☐ The act of using scientific data to support a news story
- ☐ The exclusion of any subjective content from a narrative

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11%

*You answered incorrectly. Please read the text carefully and try again.

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What is Media Bias?

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16%

*What is your age?

? Only numbers may be entered in this field.

*What gender do you identify with?

? Choose one of the following answers

- ☐ Man
- ☐ Woman
- ☐ Diverse
- ☐ Prefer not to say

*What is the highest level of education you have completed?

? Choose one of the following answers

- ☐ 8th grade
- ☐ Some high school
- ☐ High school graduate
- ☐ Vocational or technical school
- ☐ Some college
- ☐ Associate degree
- ☐ Bachelor's degree
- ☐ Graduate work
- ☐ Doctorate or PhD

☐ Prefer not to say

*What is the level of your English proficiency?

? Choose one of the following answers

- ☐ Proficient
- ☐ Independent
- ☐ Basic

*Do you consider yourself to be liberal, conservative or somewhere in between?

? Only numbers may be entered in these fields.
Your answer must be between -10 and 10

Political Orientation

Liberal

Conservative

*How often on an average do you read online news articles?

? Choose one of the following answers

- ☐ Never
- ☐ Very rarely
- ☐ Several times per month
- ☐ Several times per week
- ☐ Every day
- ☐ Several times per day

*To me personally, the topic of climate change and environmental protection is...

-5 (ir-rele-vant)	-4	-3	-2	-1	0	1	2	3	4	5 (rel- evant)
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

*Generally, environmental protection is...

-5 (un- ac- cept- able)	-4	-3	-2	-1	0	1	2	3	4	5 (ac- cept- able)
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

*Generally, environmental protection is...

-5 (bad)	-4	-3	-2	-1	0	1	2	3	4	5 (good)
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

*Generally, environmental protection is...

-5 (wron g)	-4	-3	-2	-1	0	1	2	3	4	5 (right)
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Next

38%

Please read the following news article.

More than a year into Joe Biden's presidency, the public is divided over the administration's approach to climate change: 49% of U.S. adults say the Biden administration's policies on climate change are taking the country in the right direction, while 47% say these climate policies are taking the country in the wrong direction. Climate change has been among the top priorities of the Biden administration, whose actions on the issue include rejoining the Paris Climate Agreement and passage of an infrastructure bill with funding for renewable energy. More recent legislative efforts on climate have stalled in Congress, and a Supreme Court decision in June curtailed the ability of the Environmental Protection Agency to regulate power plant emissions. Ratings of Biden's approach to climate change – and the federal government's role dealing with the issue – are deeply partisan. A majority of Republicans and independents who lean to the GOP (82%) say Biden's climate policies are taking the country in the wrong direction. Among Democrats and Democratic leaners, most say Biden is moving the country in the right direction on climate policy (79%). But in a sign of Democratic frustration with progress tackling climate change, there's discontent within the party even among those who say Biden's policies are taking the country in the right direction. Among Democrats who back the direction of the administration's climate policies, 61% say the administration could be doing a lot more on climate; far fewer (37%) say they are doing about as much as can be expected. While the public is divided over Biden's approach to climate change, a majority of Americans continue to see room for more federal action on the issue: 58% say the federal government is doing too little to reduce the effects of global climate change, compared with just 18% who say it is doing too much (22% say it is doing about the right amount). Here again, partisan differences are wide, with Democrats much more likely than Republicans to say the federal government is doing too little to reduce the effects of climate change (82% vs. 28%). Despite these polarized attitudes, the Pew Research Center survey of 10,282 U.S. adults conducted from May 2 to 8, 2022, finds broad public agreement on some specific policies to address climate change. A large majority of Americans (90%) say they favor planting about a trillion trees to

absorb carbon emissions to help reduce the effects of climate change, and 79% favor providing a tax credit to encourage businesses to develop technology to capture and store carbon emissions. Both of these policies are backed by sizable majorities of Republicans and Democrats alike. The survey, fielded before the Supreme Court's decision limiting the EPA's authority to regulate power plant emissions, finds 72% of Americans favor requiring power companies to use more energy from renewable sources, like wind and solar, and 68% back taxing corporations based on the amount of carbon emissions they produce. Partisan gaps are more pronounced on these approaches to reduce the effects of climate change, but they are not absolute. About half of Republicans – including majorities of moderate Republicans – say they favor these approaches to limiting emissions, as do most Democrats. Climate change is making extreme weather events more frequent and severe. A majority of Americans (71%) say their community has experienced at least one of five forms of extreme weather in the past year, including severe weather such as storms (43%), long periods of unusually hot weather (42%), droughts or water shortages (31%), major wildfires (21%), or rising sea levels that erode shorelines (16%). Large shares of Americans who say their communities have been impacted see climate change as contributing to these extreme weather events. For example, among the 42% of Americans who say they have experienced unusually hot weather in the last year, 61% say climate change contributed a lot and 30% think it contributed a little. Across all five forms of extreme weather included in the survey, more than eight-in-ten of those who say they've been impacted view climate change as having contributed a lot or a little to the event. Other key findings include: A 55% majority opposes phasing out the production of new gasoline cars and trucks by 2035, while 43% are in favor. Opposition is

slightly higher today than it was in April 2021, when 51% opposed and 47% favored this idea. Partisans remain far apart on this proposal: 82% of Republicans and those who lean to the GOP say they oppose phasing out the production of new gas-powered vehicles by 2035, while 65% of Democrats and Democratic leaners say they favor this. 42% of U.S. adults say they are very or somewhat likely to seriously consider purchasing an electric vehicle (EV). About as many (45%) say they are not too or not at all interested in an EV. Interest in purchasing an EV is about the same as it was in the spring of 2021, before gas prices in the U.S. rose sharply from an average of \$2.95 in April 2021 to \$4.55 in May 2022. Roughly seven-in-ten of those at least somewhat likely to consider an EV in the future cite saving money on gas as well as helping the environment as reasons why. By 53% to 45%, Americans are more likely to view stricter environmental laws as worth the cost than to say they cost too many jobs and hurt the economy. However, this view is less widely held today than it was in September of 2019, when about two-thirds (65%) said stricter environmental laws and regulations were worth the cost.

The "Next" button will show up once the minimal reading time is reached.

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72%

*Please tell us what you think about the following sentence: In my opinion, this article is biased.

🔗 Choose one of the following answers

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Somewhat disagree
- ☐ Somewhat agree
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

*Please tell us your impression of the article you just read. The article is...

🔗 Please indicate one of the following options.

	-3	-2	-1	0	1	2	3	
Inaccurate	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Accurate
Bad	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Good
Believable	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Not believable
Biased	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Unbiased
Untrustworthy	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Trustworthy
Not telling the whole story	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Telling the whole story
Unethical	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Ethical

False	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Factual
Unfair	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Fair
Imbalanced	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Balanced
Immoral	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Moral
Uninformative	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Informative
Liberal	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Conservative
Not favoring a side	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Favoring a side

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77%

Please read the following text about the article.

The Pew Research Center article is largely unbiased in its presentation of public opinion on climate change policies and related issues. It adheres to the principles of neutral reporting by providing data-driven insights, using non-inflammatory language, and presenting perspectives from across the political spectrum.

The article balances contrasting views, highlighting both Democratic and Republican stances on climate change, federal action, and specific policies like transitioning to renewable energy and electric vehicles. It avoids using emotionally charged terms or framing one side as superior to the other. The inclusion of data points, such as percentages and survey results, further strengthens the article's factual basis.

However, while the article is predominantly impartial, subtle bias might be inferred in its framing. For example, emphasizing areas of bipartisan agreement, such as support for tree planting and tax cred-

its for carbon capture, could reflect an effort to highlight unity amidst polarization. Additionally, framing climate change as a contributing factor to extreme weather might lean slightly toward a particular narrative, even though it is supported by survey data.

Overall, the article is a strong example of objective reporting, with any potential bias being minimal and likely unintentional. The reliance on data and balanced representation of opinions promotes an informed understanding of the topic.

The "Next" button will show up once the minimal reading time is reached.

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83%

*After reading the short text after the article, please tell us what you think about the following sentence: In my opinion, this article is biased.

🔗 (The very first news article you read, NOT the shorter text that followed)

🔗 Choose one of the following answers

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Somewhat disagree
- ☐ Somewhat agree
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

*After reading the short text after the article, please tell us your impression of the article you just read. The article is...

🔗 The very first news article you read, NOT the shorter text that followed

	-3	-2	-1	0	1	2	3	
Inaccurate	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Accurate
Bad	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Good
Believable	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Not believable
Biased	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Unbiased
Untrustworthy	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Trustworthy
Not telling the whole story	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Telling the whole story
Unethical	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Ethical
False	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Factual

Unfair	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Fair
Imbalanced	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Balanced
Immoral	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Moral
Uninformative	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Informative
Liberal	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Conservative
Not favoring a side	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Favoring a side

*The explanation was...

❓ (question regards the explanation, the short text after the article, NOT the article)

	-3	-2	-1	0	1	2	3	
not understandable	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	understandable
valuable	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	inferior
obstructive	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	supportive
good	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	bad
complicated	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	easy
clear	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	confusing

*The explanation was complete.

❓ (question regards the explanation text after the article, NOT the article)

	-3	-2	-1	0	1	2	3	
agree	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	disagree

*The explanation was useful.

❓ (question regards the explanation text after the article, NOT the article)

	-3	-2	-1	0	1	2	3	
agree	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	disagree

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Next

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88%

*What did you find most useful/helpful about the explanation?

*What improvements would you suggest?

*This doesn't impact your payment: How attentively did you read the article?

🔍 (question regards the article itself)

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	
I did not read it	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	I read very attentively

*This doesn't impact your payment: How attentively did you read the text after the article?

🔍 (question regards the explanation text after the article, NOT the article)

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	
I did not read it	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	I read very attentively

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94%

Thank you so much!!! You have successfully completed our survey.

Our research group focuses on the automatic detection of media bias through classifiers and AIs. Our main goal is the help people to read more bias-aware and think critically while consuming news. In this study, we tested the performance of automatically Large Language Model (LLM, for example ChatGPT) generated AI explanations compared to human explanation texts and a control text with a summary of the article. This helps us evaluate if LLM-generated bias explanations can be effective in increasing media literacy. We later plan to implement them in end-user tools that are useful and scalable. Your feedback further helps us to adapt and improve the way AI (or humans!) explain media bias.

Thank you for your participation. If you have further questions or comments, please feel free to contact [\[REDACTED\]](#)

Please click on the button below to navigate to Prolific to receive your payment.

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